

Thomas Villalobos Roberts

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EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia Karsh Institute of Democracy - Research Lead | Remote 2023-Present

- Lead research at a multi-institution lab on the institutional conditions for democracy and capitalism, coordinating faculty, analysts, and research staff across disciplines and owning scope, timelines, and deliverables end to end
- Translated complex quantitative research into clear findings, memos, and briefings tailored to senior stakeholders, faculty, and nontechnical external audiences, authoring a 200+ page report and multiple peer reviewed working papers
- Developed the theoretical framework and quantitative research approach for the Global Capitalism Index, covering the core dimensions of economic systems across 169 countries and 16 years of data
- Guided data analysis, standardization, and principal components analysis using 300+ datasets
- Designed and led a peer review process across eight domains, coordinating outside experts and publishing critiques and responses to ensure findings were rigorously tested and communicated
- Tested the index as a forward indicator of emerging market equity risk using multivariate decomposition and backtests built on derived institutional risk signals

Goldman Sachs - Analyst | New York, NY 2021-2023

- Client Solutions & Capital Markets analyst focused on US institutional insurance client base
- Served as primary point of contact for institutional clients, coordinating across portfolio managers, research analysts, and traders to respond to inquiries and deliver tailored analysis
- Translated market, sector, and economic developments into clear, timely briefings for client decision makers under time pressure

EDUCATION

University of Virginia - *M.P.P. Accelerated Master of Public Policy* | Charlottesville, VA 2019-2021

Overall GPA: 3.83

Thesis: *Closing the Racial Gap in Retirement Security* in partnership with The Brookings Institution

Relevant Coursework: Advanced Modern Finance, Financial Crises and Civic Reaction, Research Methods & Data Analysis I & II, Advanced Impact Analysis, Economics of Public Policy, Game Theory

Involvements: Graduate Council President, Raven Academic Honor Society

University of Virginia - *B.A. Political Science* | Charlottesville, VA 2016-2020

Major GPA: 3.6

Relevant Coursework: American Political Economy, Comparative Economic Policy, Politics of Developing Areas, Political Economy Independent Thesis, British Economic History, Economics of Social Insurance

Awards: Sky Alland Scholarship Recipient

Involvements: University Historical Tour Guide, Honor Committee Investigator, Seriatim Journal of Politics Managing Editor, Refugee ESL Instructor, Local Economic Development Research Fellow

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: R, Stata, Excel, LaTeX, Tableau

Languages: Portuguese (*Conversational*), Spanish (*Conversational*)

Interests: Independent musician, travel, hiking (*Camino de Santiago*)